they were on the side of right; both had read every word of abuse in the press and on social media, going back months and months.

At six P.M. it was done. We gathered around the laptop, read the draft one last time. One staffer messaged the private secretaries of Granny, Pa and Willy, told them what was coming. Willy's guy replied immediately: *This is going to go nuclear.*

I knew, of course, that many Britons would be shocked, and saddened, which made my stomach churn. But in due course, once they knew the truth, I felt confident they'd understand.

One of the staffers said: *Are we doing this?*

Meg and I both said:

Yes. There's no other choice.

We sent the statement to our social media person. Within a minute there it was, live, on our Instagram page, the only platform available to us. We all hugged, wiped our eyes, and quickly gathered our things.

Meg and I walked out of the Palace and jumped into our car. As we sped towards Frogmore the news was already on the radio. Every channel. We picked one. Magic FM. Meg's favorite. We listened to the presenter work himself into a very British lather. We held hands and shared a smile with our bodyguards in the front seat. Then we all gazed silently out of the windows.

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DAYS LATER THERE was a meeting at Sandringham. I don't remember who called it the Sandringham Summit. Someone in the press, I suspect.

On my way there I got a text from Marko about a story in *The Times*.

Willy was declaring that he and I were now "separate entities."

"I've put my arm around my brother all our lives and I can't do that anymore," he said.

Meg had gone back to Canada to be with Archie, so I was on my own for this summit. I got there early, hoping to have a quick chat with Granny. She was sitting on a bench before the fireplace and I sat down beside her. I saw the Wasp